

Flows: versions, explanation, and visual path

Status: Working. Flows are grouped by name without discarding versions. Users explicitly select the version to retrieve and explain.

Version and metadata behavior

- The list shows Flow type and version count. The version picker shows version number, Active/Draft status, and ProcessType.
- The selected Flow record is retrieved from the Tooling API. The parser reads the returned Metadata object when present and preserves the full retrieved record otherwise.
- Expandable sections identify start conditions, input variables, decisions, assignments, record lookups/creates/updates/deletes, actions, subflows, screens, waits, and pauses by element name.
- Element counts and names are structural facts. Meaning that depends on formulas, expressions, runtime data, or unsupported elements is not stated as certain.

Visual path algorithm

- The renderer reads start.connector.targetReference and follows each supported element connector in order.
- Each node shows the Flow element name and collection type. faultConnector targets are shown on the originating node.
- Traversal is cycle-safe and capped at 100 connected nodes. Remaining recognized but unreachable elements are appended so they are not silently omitted.
- The diagram is intentionally a compact horizontal path, not a replacement for Flow Builder. Branch labels, complex loops, scheduled paths, and every outcome connector are not fully modeled.

Testing and verification

Check	Result
Static checks	TypeScript and ESLint pass.
Automated tests	17 files and 158 tests pass, including class parsing, trigger handler/timing, active and inactive Flow versions, and connector/fault path generation.
Production build	esbuild produces dist/sidepanel.js and dist/background.js.
Live-org dependency	End-to-end metadata coverage depends on the connected user permissions and the exact Tooling Metadata shape returned by that Salesforce API version.

Limitations

The explainer is deterministic and local, not semantic AI. It does not execute Apex or Flows, calculate runtime formulas, guarantee dependency completeness, or prove side effects hidden behind inaccessible code. Unsupported Flow elements remain visible in the raw metadata. The current visual path is connector-based and linearized; use Salesforce Flow Builder for the authoritative full graph.